

Windows OpenGL Support

Backward Compatibility Guide

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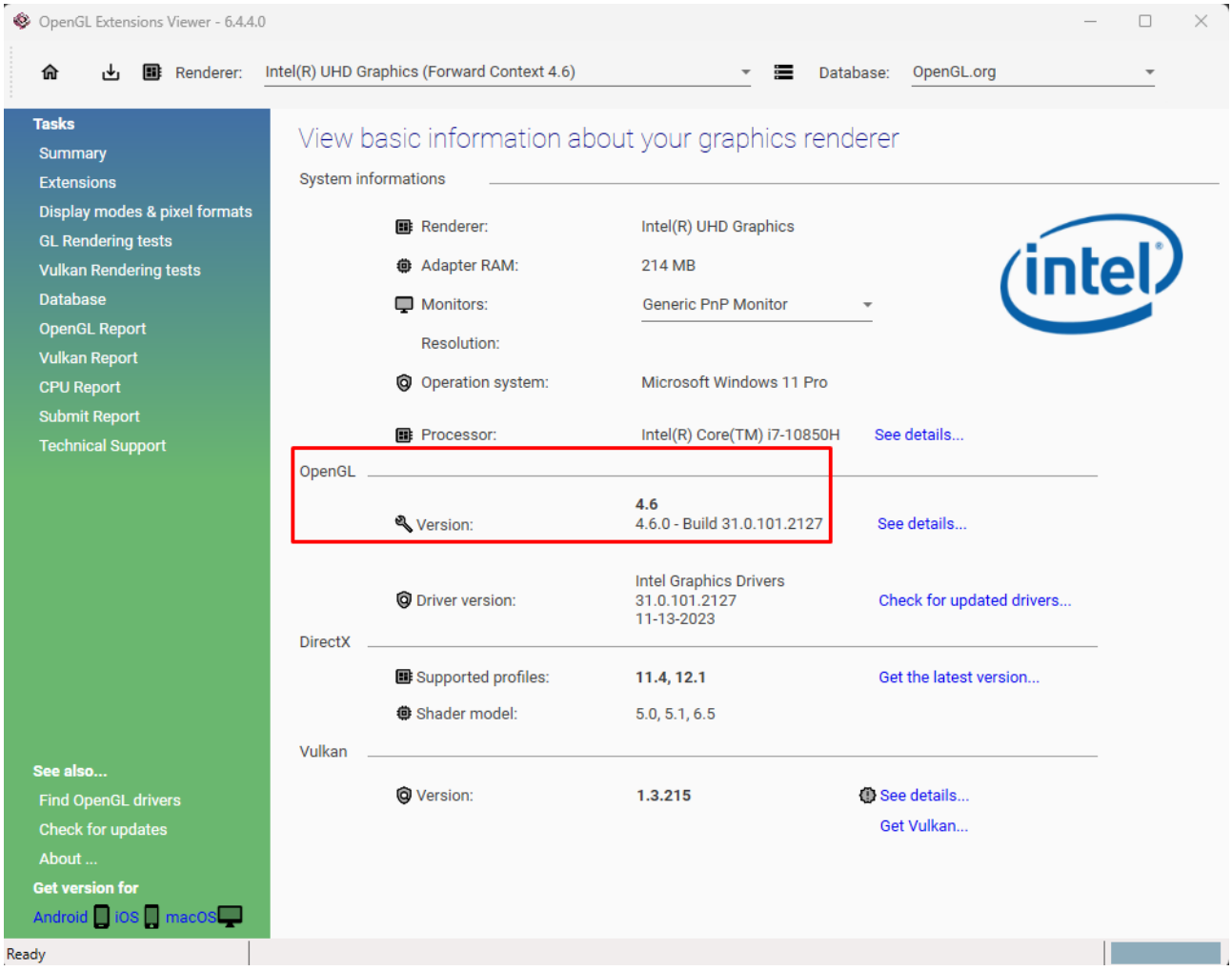
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1 Introduction

Many Sixdof software products include Graphical User Interface (GUI) programs to enable rapid testing and integration. Typically the GUI software has a dependency on a specific version of OpenGL. Older computers that have graphics cards that do not support the correct version of OpenGL will not be able to open the GUI programs by default. In this document we demonstrate how to get the GUI programs working even on older computers.

2 OpenGL Compatibility

Currently, Sixdof GUI software products require OpenGL version 3.3 or higher. The version of OpenGL that your computer has, depends on your graphics card and the hardware drivers. Often updating your graphics card driver can fix the problem. However, many older graphics cards do not have the hardware necessary to upgrade to the latest version of OpenGL. To check your OpenGL version you can download the free OpenGL Extensions Viewer tool:



If the version displayed is less than 3.3, the GUI software will not work by default. Proceed to the next section for a software fix to the problem.

3 Solution

The solution to the problem is to provide a software implementation of the missing OpenGL functionality. This can be done by the following steps:

1. Copy the provided `opengl32.dll` shared library file to the folder containing the GUI software.
2. Open a Windows Command Prompt and navigate to the folder containing the GUI software.
3. Run the following commands from the Command Prompt:
   - `set LIBGL_ALWAYS_SOFTWARE=1`
   - `set MESA_GL_VERSION_OVERRIDE=3.3`
4. Run the GUI program from the Command Prompt:
   - `<program_name>.exe`

When running the Sixdof GUI software, by using this fix, you may experience slower performance compared to a computer with a modern graphics card. Therefore, the speed does not reflect the actual speed of the Sixdof system.